

The two thresholds reach different populations

Chicago employers in 2025, by corporate parent. The old tax applied at 50 employees; the proposal applies at 500

	50 or more employees	500 or more employees
Firms reached	3,566	243
Their Chicago employment	751,680	388,336
Median firm size	82	900
Mean Chicago locations	3.4	20.5
Share with more than one location	24%	76%
Median reported sales	\$10.9M	\$193M
Employment in portable sectors (Tier 2)	28%	30%
Largest sector by employment	Health care 14%	Health care 17%
Employment vendor-verified	84%	90%
Individual locations at the threshold	4,016	198

Firms are corporate parents (Employer's Expense Tax Ruling #2), which combined employees across commonly owned companies for the 50-employee test. Establishments are individual locations, shown for comparison. Employment is Chicago only. Government employers and single-location records reporting more employees than their own parent record are removed at both thresholds, the same base as the revenue exhibits. Portable sectors are finance, information, professional and technical services and management of companies. Vendor-verified means the headcount came from the business rather than being modelled. Source: Data Axle (Infogroup) 2025 business file, establishments in the City of Chicago.